

Women in Aquaculture

Grant Writing for Aquaculture Projects

Tips, Templates & Funding Directory

Women in Aquaculture (WiA)

Published 2025 | womeninaquaculture.org

This publication is produced by Women in Aquaculture (WiA), a global non-profit platform
connecting, supporting and celebrating women across the aquaculture industry.

Finding the Right Grants

Before writing a proposal, invest time finding grants that align with your project:

- National fisheries and aquaculture development agencies
 - International organisations (FAO, WorldFish, CGIAR)
 - Women's empowerment and gender equity funds
 - Climate adaptation and sustainable development programmes
 - Private foundations focused on food security and blue economy
 - Research councils and university collaboration programmes
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Writing a Strong Proposal

Key elements of a successful grant application:

- **Problem statement** — what challenge does your project address?
- **Objectives** — what will you achieve, and by when?
- **Methodology** — how will you do it? Be detailed and realistic
- **Impact** — who benefits, and how will you measure success?
- **Budget** — detailed, justified, aligned with funder guidelines
- **Sustainability** — how will the project continue after funding?
- **Team** — demonstrate relevant expertise and track record

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Applying to grants that don't match your scope or stage
 - Writing vague objectives without measurable outcomes
 - Underestimating costs or padding budgets without justification
 - Ignoring the funder's specific priorities and criteria
 - Submitting last minute without review or proofreading
 - Failing to demonstrate community engagement
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Budget Tips

Your budget should be:

- **Detailed** — itemise every cost category
 - **Justified** — explain why each cost is necessary
 - **Realistic** — neither too high nor suspiciously low
 - **Aligned** — match the funder's eligible cost categories
 - **Include contingency** — typically 5-10% for unexpected costs
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After Submission

If Successful

Negotiate terms carefully, set up reporting systems from day one, deliver on your promises, and maintain the funder relationship for future opportunities.

If Unsuccessful

Request feedback, revise your proposal, and apply elsewhere. Many successful projects were funded on the second or third attempt. Persistence pays off.